

NAUDHIZ — WE NEEDED

NO VISION. ONLY WORDS, SCRATCHED INTO
THE STONE BEHIND THESE SHIELDS.

Nine of us came. One family. We had no tribe anymore; Rome had taken the name from us before we understood what that meant.

We brought nine shields. One each. We asked Mars to remember us since no one else would. We did not ask for victory. We did not ask for justice. We asked to be remembered.

There is no record of us in Roman archives. We checked, later, when some of us learned Latin. The Romans erased us so completely that even the account of our erasure is gone.

NAUDHIZ. Need. We were in need.

We came here once. We left nine shields. We did not come back.

If you are reading this, Mars kept his word. We exist here, in this stone, on these shields, and now in your memory.

That is enough.

That will have to be enough.

Behind the nine shields, the wall is bare
stone. No runes. No names.